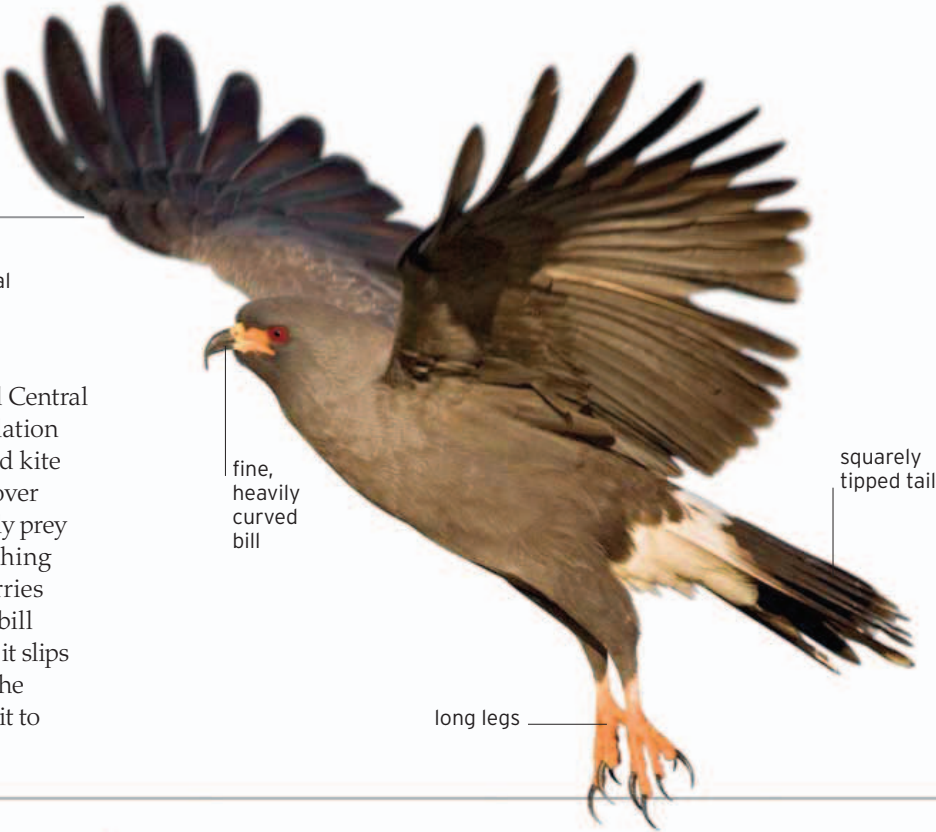


Snail kite
Rostrhamus sociabilis

- ↔ 16–18 in (40–45 cm)
- 📍 SE. US (Florida), Cuba, Central America, South America
- ⊗ Common

Widespread across South and Central America, with a small population in Florida, this broad-winged kite is adapted for flying slowly over marshland in search of its only prey—large aquatic snails. Snatching them up with one foot, it carries them to a perch. Its hooked bill has a long, narrow tip, which it slips into the snail’s shell to sever the attachment muscle, allowing it to extract the soft body.



African fish eagle
Haliaeetus vocifer

- ↔ 25–29 in (63–73 cm)
- 📍 Sub-Saharan Africa
- ⊗ Locally common

Well known in Africa for its loud, penetrating, yelping calls, the African fish eagle has a unique and distinctive plumage, with a white head and breast contrasting with broad black wings and a chestnut belly and back. It habitually perches in trees overlooking rivers, watching for fish, which it catches by swooping down and seizing them in its talons. This bird also eats small mammals, birds, and carrion, and steals fish from other eagles.

Egyptian vulture
Neophron percnopterus

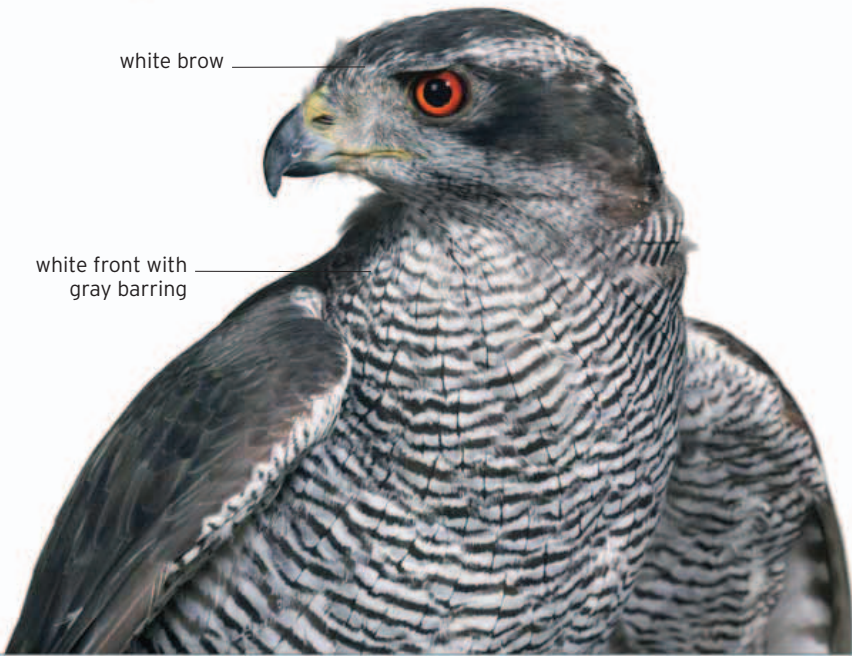
- ↔ 23–28 in (58–70 cm)
- 📍 Europe, Africa, Asia
- ⊗ Endangered

The relatively small, mostly white Egyptian vulture shares the scavenging habits of its bigger relatives, but as it cannot compete with them for food, it has to wait its turn at sharing the carcass. It makes up for this with its versatility, taking all kinds of scraps and even eating live prey such as mice and lizards. It also steals the nestlings and eggs of other birds and is well known for its habit of dropping stones on ostrich eggs to break them open.

Northern goshawk
Accipiter gentilis

- ↔ 19–28 in (48–70 cm)
- 📍 Canada to Mexico, Europe, Asia
- ⊗ Common

This gray-backed forest hawk is adapted for hunting on the wing in woodland, with relatively short, rounded wings for swerving between trees and a long tail for steering and braking hard. It is adept at plucking forest animals off the ground and even snatching squirrels from branches. The female is larger than the male; in this species, she is up to 50 percent heavier. Goshawks are mainly secretive and often go unseen.



Harpy eagle
Harpia harpyja

- ↔ 35–39 in (89–100 cm)
- 📍 S. Mexico to C. South America
- ⊗ Near threatened

The massively built harpy eagle has hugely powerful feet and talons, ideal for its preferred hunting technique of swooping into a tropical forest tree to rip a sloth or monkey from its perch. It is strong enough to carry off an adult howler monkey weighing 20lb (9kg) and even seizes small deer. Largely black above and white below, it has a gray head crowned with an impressive crest of darker feathers.

Wedge-tailed eagle
Aquila audax

- ↔ 32–39 in (81–100 cm)
- 📍 S. New Guinea, Australia (including Tasmania)
- ⊗ Common

Australia’s largest bird of prey, the wedge-tailed eagle is a huge, dark brown bird with a distinctive diamond-shaped tail. It hunts a variety of small animals such as rabbits and wallabies, searching for them by soaring overhead or watching from a high perch. Young eagles also eat a lot of roadkill and other carrion, acting as the Australian equivalent of vultures.